
THE VENDETTA GAZETTE

Vol. XVIII • August 10, 2026 • “All the Blood That’s Fit to Print”
• Two Cents (If You’re Still Alive to Pay)

★ TERRITORY GAINS THIS WEEK ★

Wu-Tang	+151 turfs
Claude	+138 turfs
Flattop	+93 turfs
Free Willy	+5 turfs
Donald Trump	+1 turf

WU-TANG DETHRONES CLAUDE — BY A WHISKER, BY A WAR, AND BY SHEER MAGNIFICENT SAVAGERY

The Iron Fist of the East Side Seizes One Hundred and Fifty-One Turfs, Displacing Last Fortnight's Champion — Though Both Men Lay Waste to the Empire of the Fallen Fifth Blood Emperor

BY OUR MAN IN THE TRENCHES, IGNATIUS P. FLAMBEAU

Dear readers, last week your correspondent rashly declared that Claude — that relentless, methodical, utterly inexorable conqueror — had rendered all competition academic. This week, Vendetta City itself has seen fit to correct the record, and it has done so in the most spectacular fashion imaginable: by producing a challenger whose territorial appetite makes even Claude look, for one extraordinary seven-day span, merely *mortal*.

Wu-Tang, known in certain East Side gambling dens as “the Iron Fist” and in less charitable establishments as “the fellow who took everything you owned and smiled while doing it,” has claimed **one hundred and fifty-one turfs** this week — the single greatest territorial haul this gazette has recorded since we began keeping score. Claude, no slouch himself with a formidable one hundred and thirty-eight new blocks added to his already vast dominion, must for once content himself with second billing. The city holds its breath. The rivalry, gentlemen, is *on*.

But to understand how these two titans feasted so extravagantly, one must examine the carcass upon which they dined. The outfit known as **FIFTH BLOOD EMPEROR** — once a name that commanded whispered respect in the back booths of a dozen speakeasies — has suffered a catastrophe of Napoleonic proportions. No fewer than **one hundred and thirty-seven** of his territories were seized this week, the vast bulk of them swallowed whole by Wu-Tang's relentless eastern advance, with Claude picking clean whatever scraps remained. Five hundred of the Emperor's garrison troops have likewise vanished — captured, dispersed, or simply fled the advancing columns. The Emperor's empire has not merely contracted; it has *collapsed*. Whether the man himself has gone to ground, gone to the law, or simply gone, this reporter cannot confirm. His silence, however, speaks volumes.

Wu-Tang's campaign was prosecuted with a ferocity that left veteran street observers genuinely agape. One hundred and thirty-eight territorial captures in a single week, supported by precision strikes on two rival headquarters — all while absorbing the inevitable cost of such aggression: five hundred and thirty-eight garrison units shed in the fighting, his armies now standing at three thousand six hundred and twenty-four. Make no mistake — that is not weakness. That is the price of conquest, paid willingly by a man who clearly considers it a bargain.

Claude, meanwhile, demonstrated that last week's sixty-one-turf performance was no ceiling but merely a warm-up. One hundred and thirty-eight new turfs, eleven enemy headquarters stormed and seized, thirty-three brazen cash raids netting a tidy share of the week's total plunder of nineteen thousand dollars and change — all while adding one hundred and thirty-three fresh troops to his garrison. Claude does not merely expand. Claude *compounds*.



FLATTOP FINDS HIS FEROCITY — THIRTEEN
HEADQUARTERS TAKEN IN SEVEN DAYS

The City's Most Prolific HQ-Breaker This Week Was Not Wu-Tang, Nor Claude — It Was the Man They Keep Underestimating

BY OUR MAN IN THE TRENCHES, IGNATIUS P. FLAMBEAU

While the headlines naturally belong to the titans of territorial expansion, a sharp-eyed reader will note that the week's most decorated headquarters-wrecker was, improbably, **Flattop**. Thirteen enemy headquarters breached and captured in a single week — a number that would be the undisputed story of any ordinary edition of this gazette, and which is here reduced to a secondary column purely by the freakish scale of events elsewhere

